CAREY COOMBS · NOVEMBER TO DECEMBER

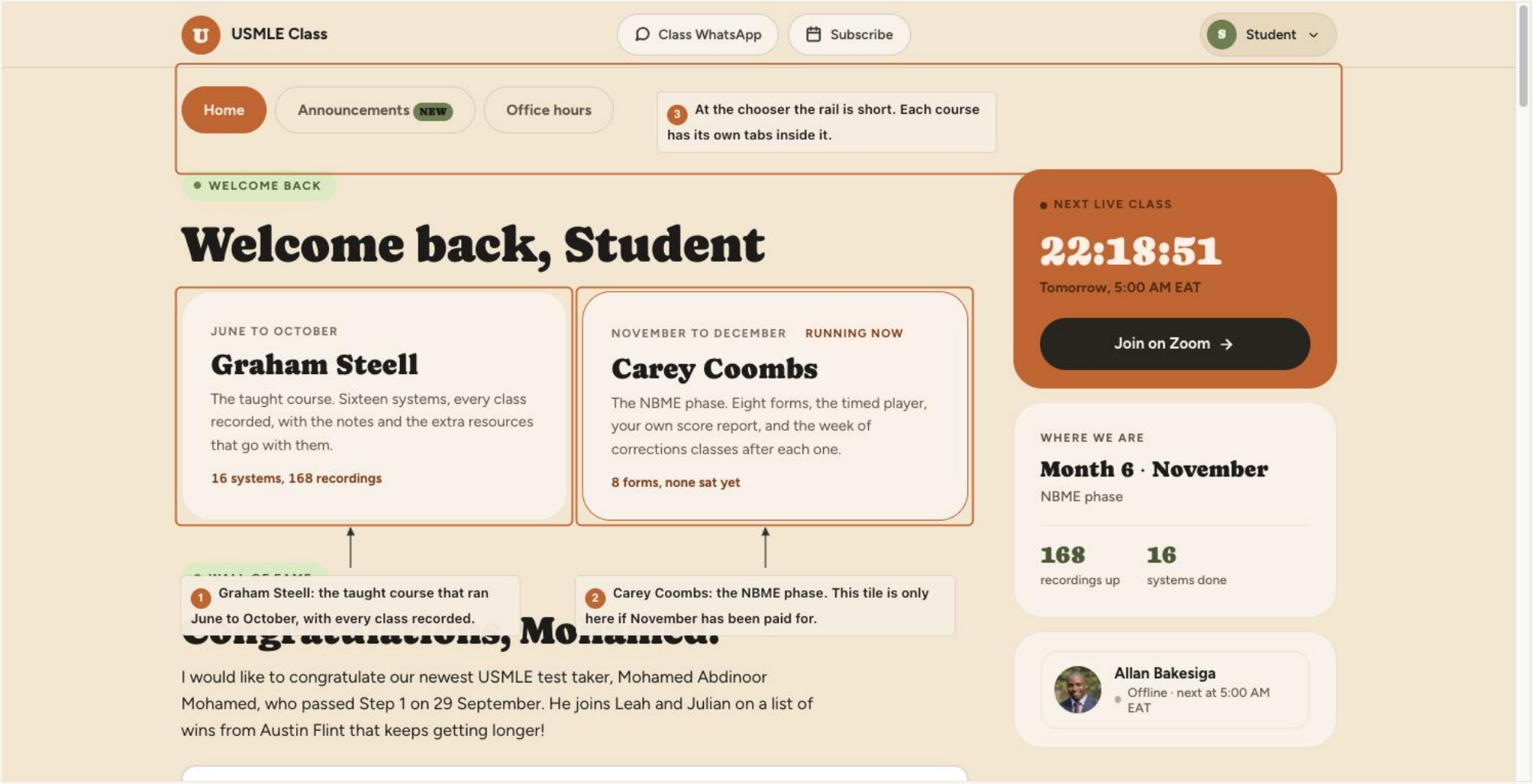
Sitting an NBME

Every screen, in the order you will meet them

Eight self assessments across November and December. You sit each one on your own over the weekend, then we spend Monday to Friday on the questions most of the class got wrong.

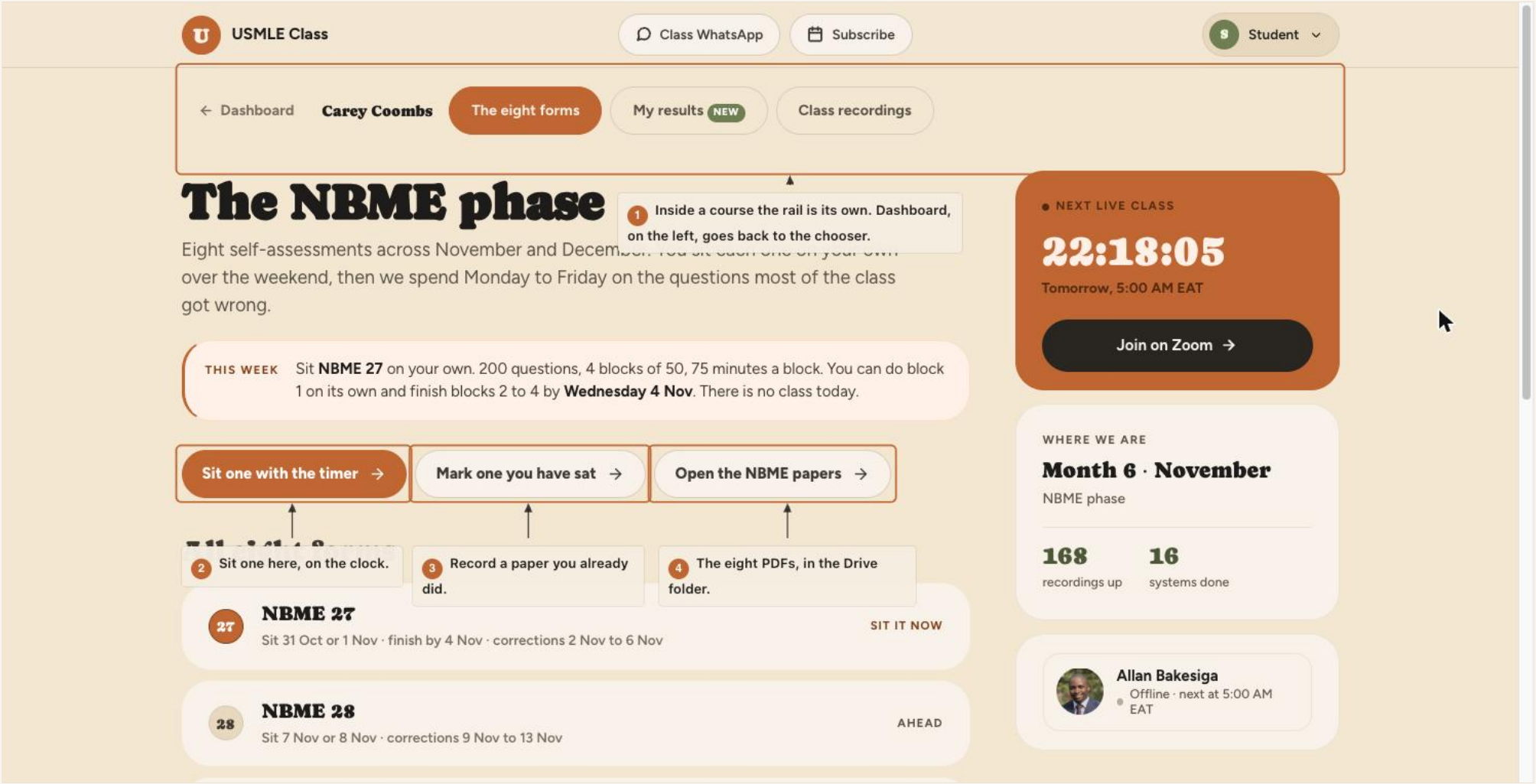
This guide walks the whole thing: signing in, the timer, the lab values, the break, the marking and the send. The last page is the six rules worth remembering.

Signing in



1. Open bakesiga.github.io/usmle-dashboard and sign in with the Google address Allan has for you.
2. There is no separate NBME account and no second password. The address you already use is the one that works.
3. You land on a chooser. Graham Steell is the taught course from June to October. Carey Coombs is the NBME phase.

Finding the forms



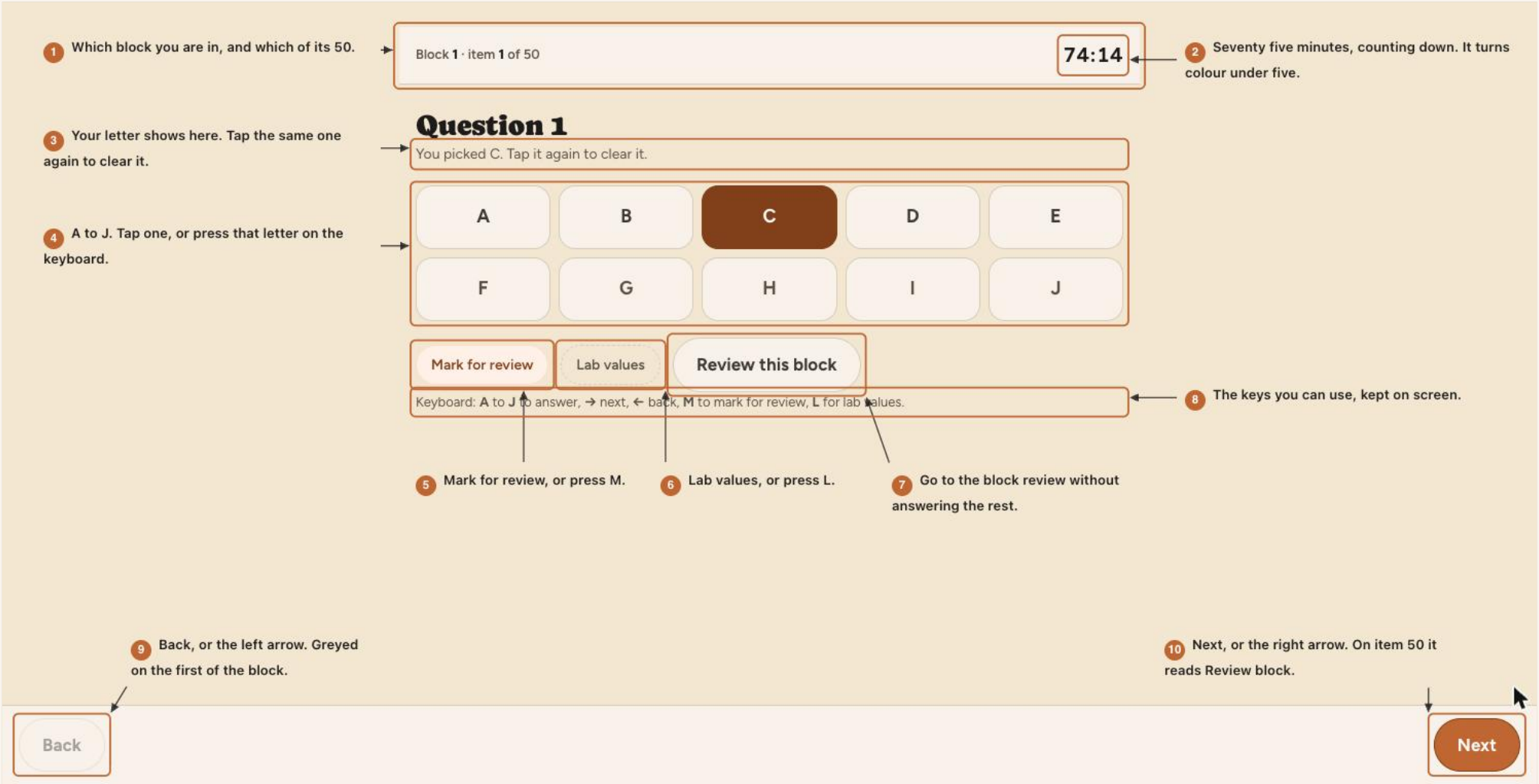
1. Carey Coombs, then The eight forms. This panel always says which form is live this week and when it is due.
2. Three ways on: sit one on the clock, record a paper you have already done, or open the PDFs in Drive.
3. Open your paper before you start the timer. The page keeps time and takes your answers, it does not show you questions.

Picking your form



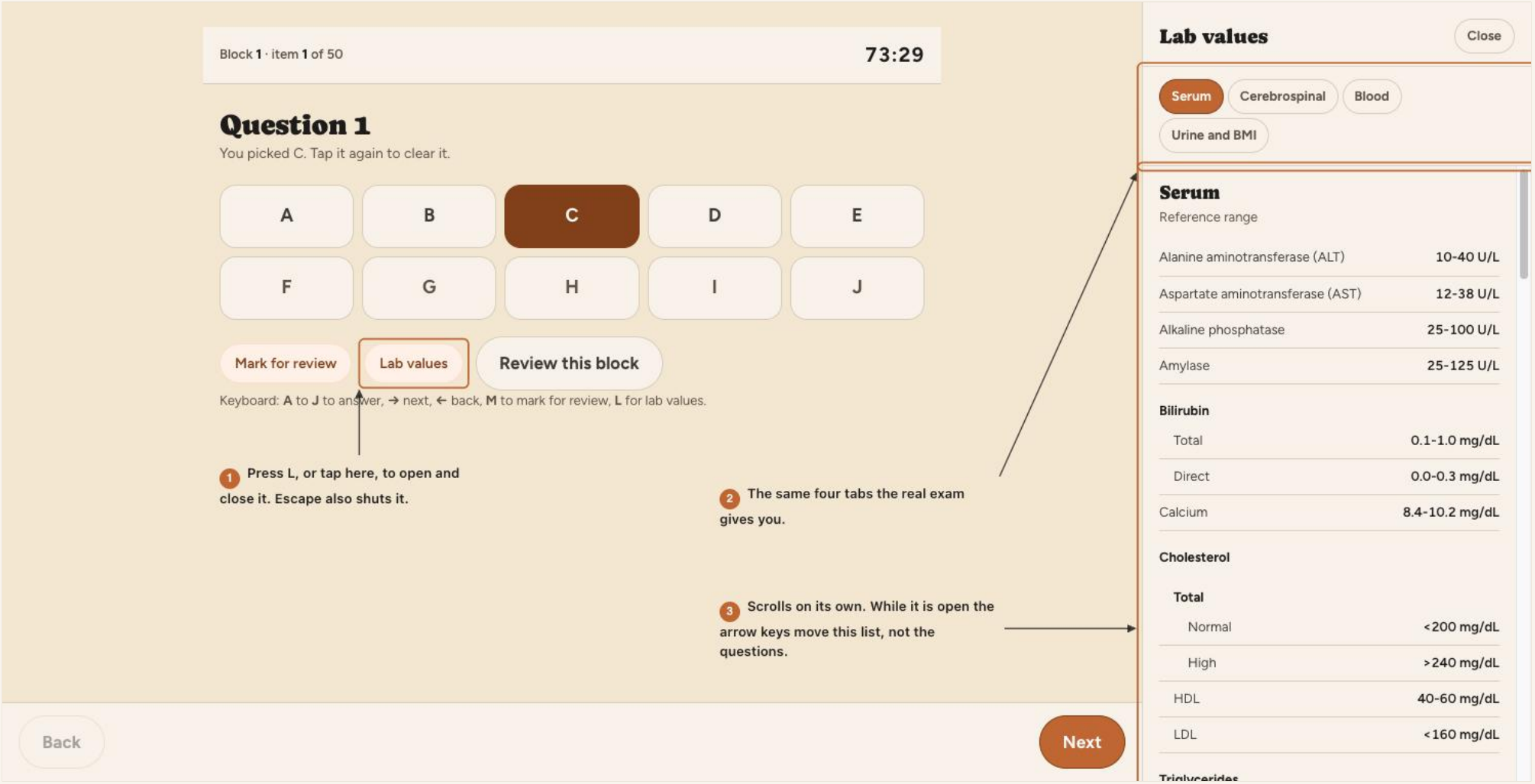
1. Only the form the class is on can be picked. The rest are greyed until their own weekend, so you cannot sit the wrong one.
2. Seventy five minutes a block of 50, a minute and a half a question. That is the real pace and there is no other setting.
3. If a form can be split, the page says so and gives you the date the remaining blocks are due.

The question screen



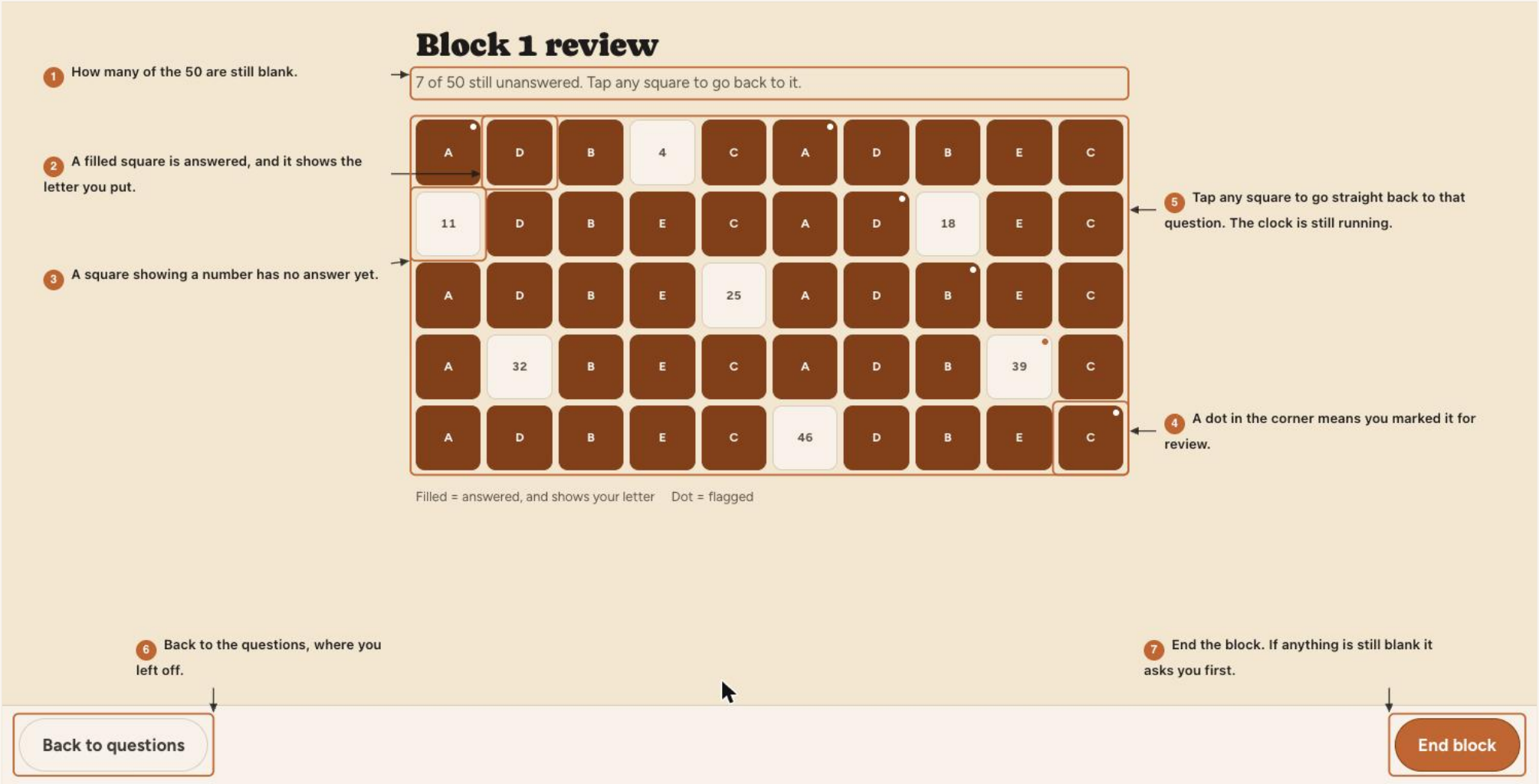
1. Read the question on your paper, put the letter here. Tapping the same letter again clears it.
2. Everything has a key: A to J answer, the arrows move, M marks for review, L opens the lab values.
3. Your work is saved on every tap, so a closed tab or a flat battery does not cost you the block.

Lab values, on every question



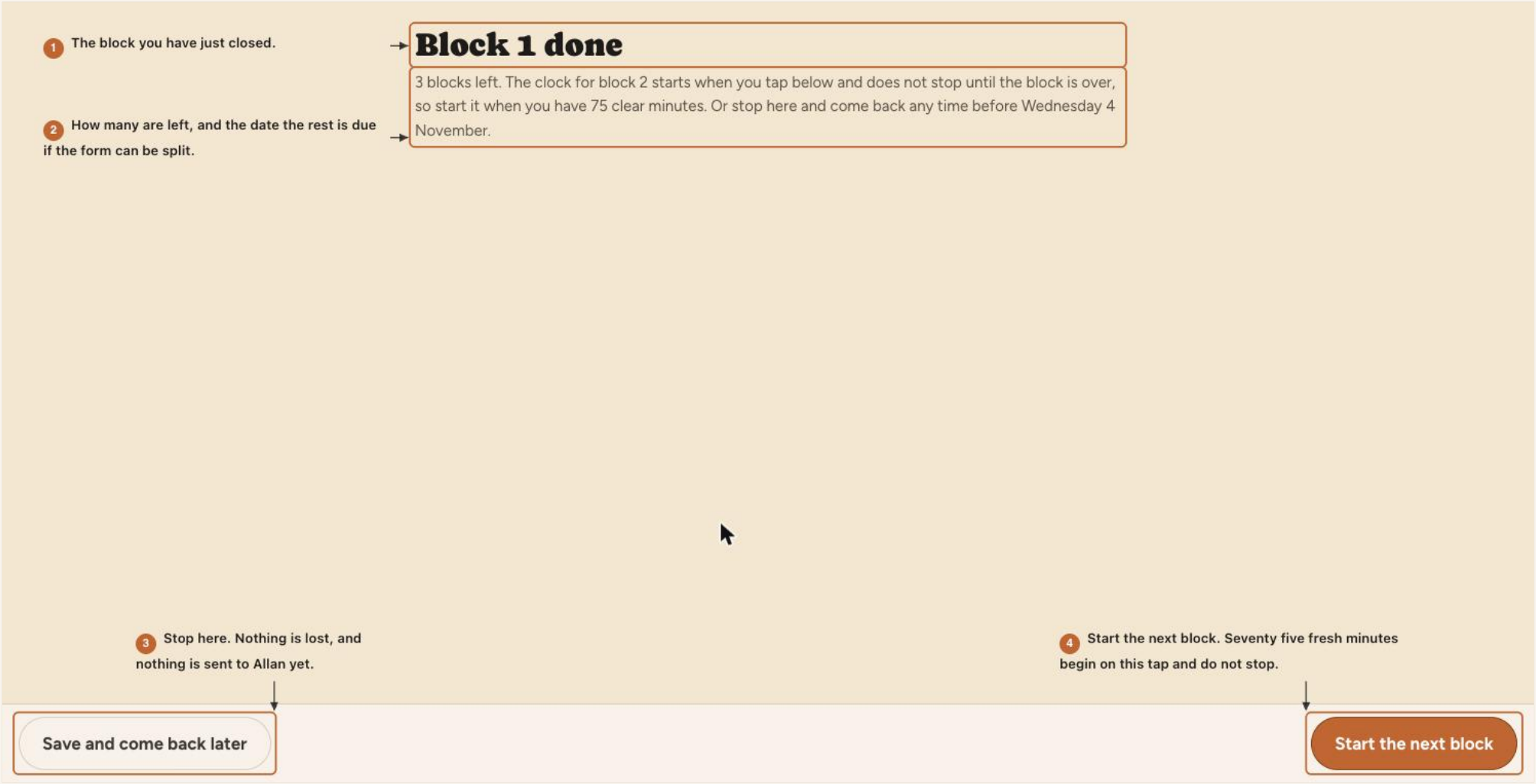
1. The same four tabs the real exam gives you, open on any question, scrolling on its own.
2. Leave it open if you like. While it is open the arrow keys move the table rather than the questions, so you cannot skip ahead by accident.
3. Press L to open or close it, or Escape to shut it.

The block review



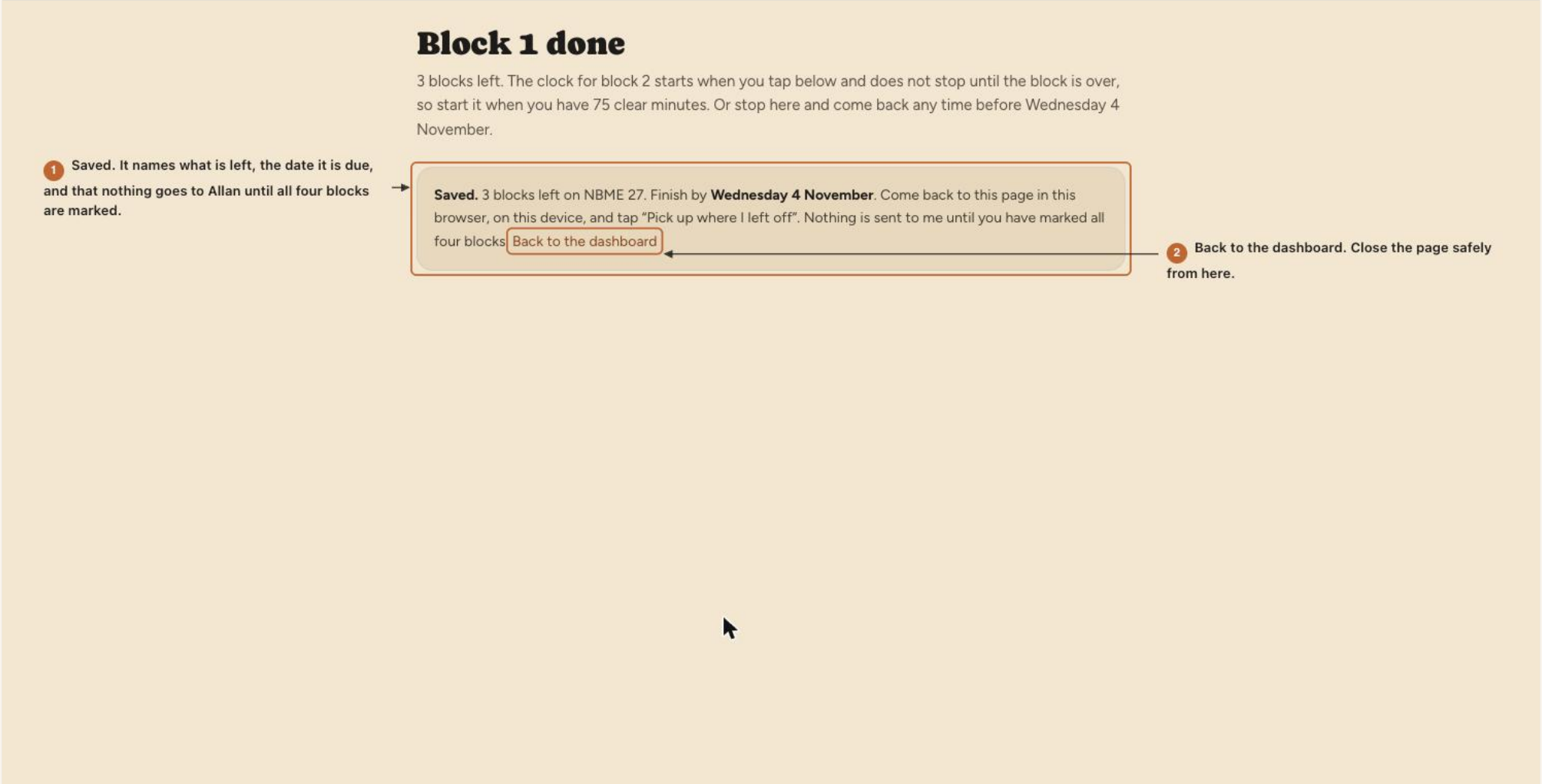
1. At the end of the 50, or whenever you tap Review this block, you see all fifty at once.
2. Filled squares carry the letter you put. Numbered squares are still blank. A dot means you marked it for review.
3. Tap any square to go back to it. The clock is still running while you do.

The break



1. Between blocks. Nothing has been sent and nothing is lost.
2. The clock for the next block starts when you tap Start the next block, and it does not stop once it has started.
3. Only start it when you have seventy five clear minutes.

Stopping and coming back



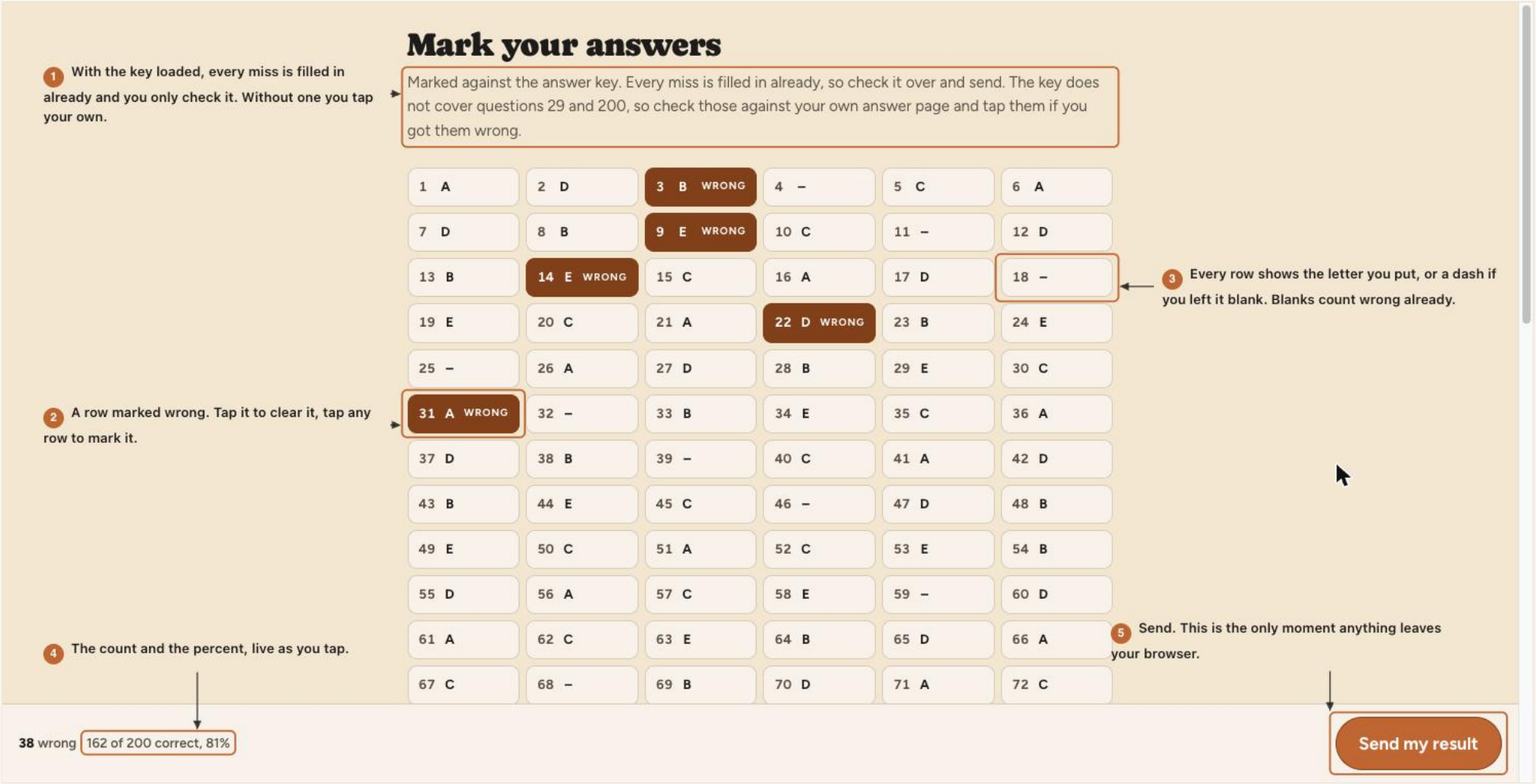
1. Save and come back later is a real stop, not a pause. You can close the page and come back tomorrow.
2. Come back in the same browser on the same device. Your answers live in that browser, not in your account.
3. Nothing reaches Allan until you have marked all four blocks.

Picking it up again



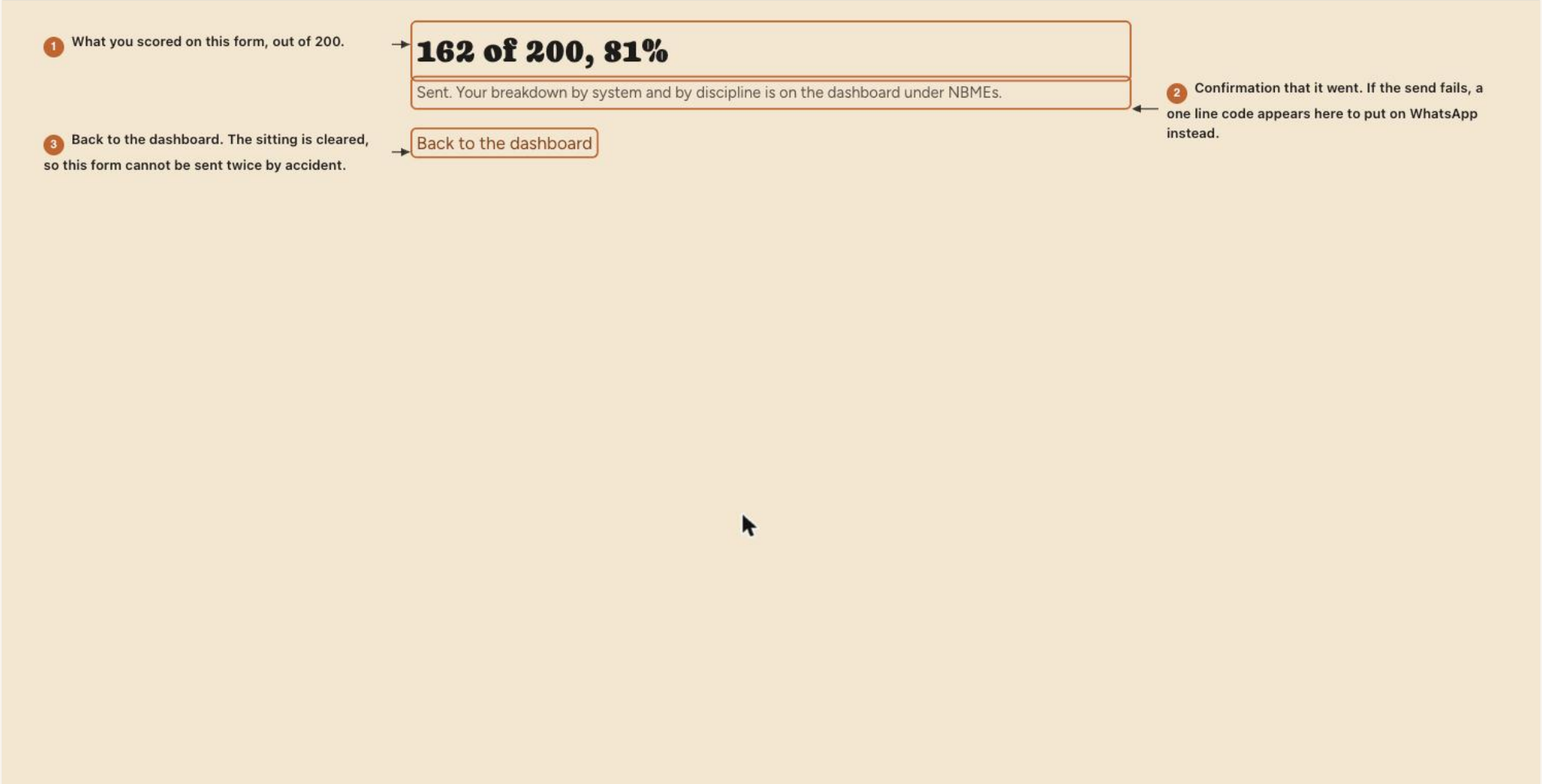
1. Open the sitting page again and it tells you which form, where you stopped, how many you have answered and the date the rest is due.
2. Pick up where I left off puts you back exactly where you were, whether that is a break, a block, or the marking.
3. Starting fresh asks you first, because it throws the saved sitting away.

Marking it



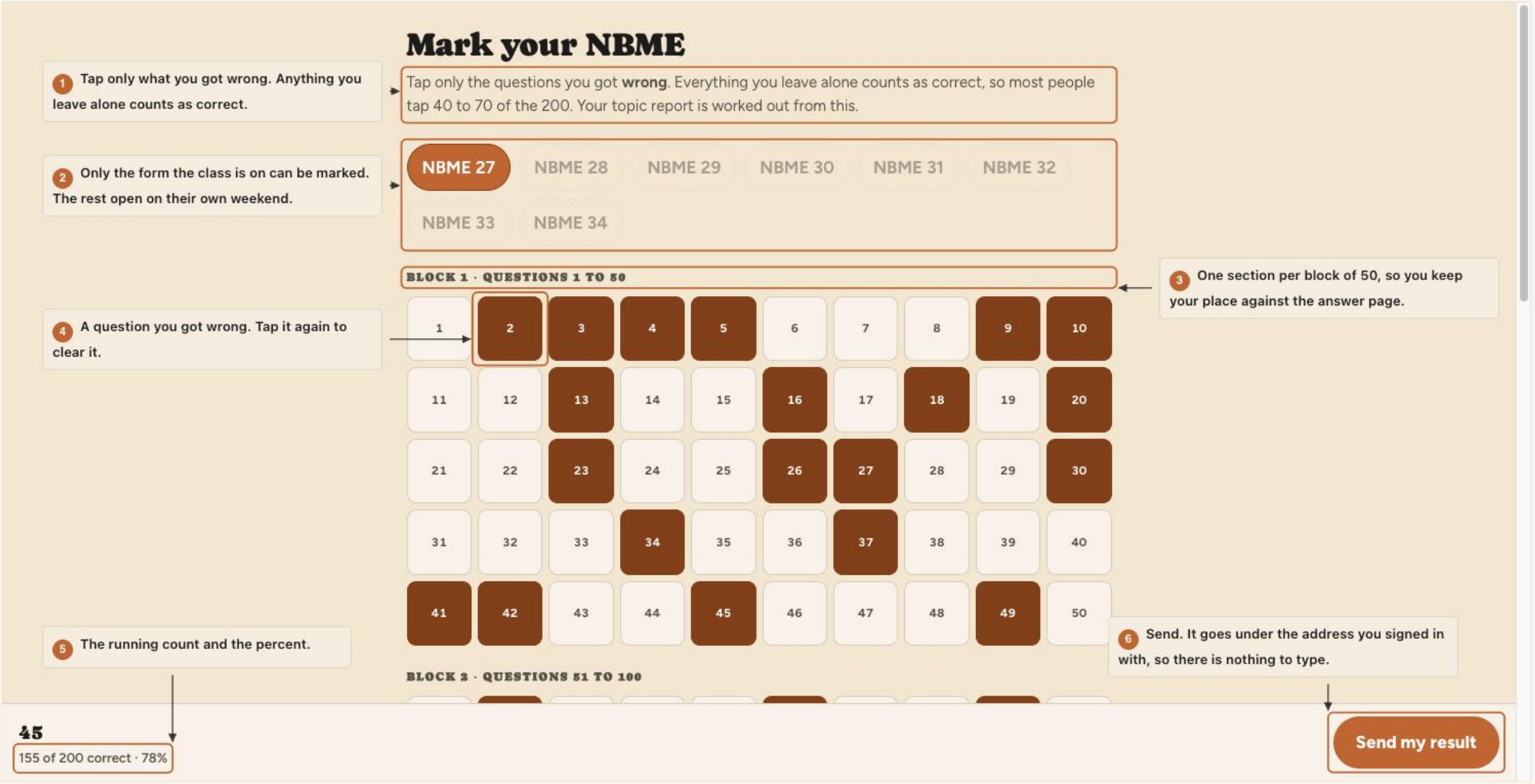
1. After block 4. Every row shows the letter you actually put, or a dash if you left it blank.
2. If Allan has loaded the answer key, every miss is filled in for you and you only check it over.
3. If not, open the NBME answer page and tap the ones you got wrong. Blanks are counted wrong already.

Sending it



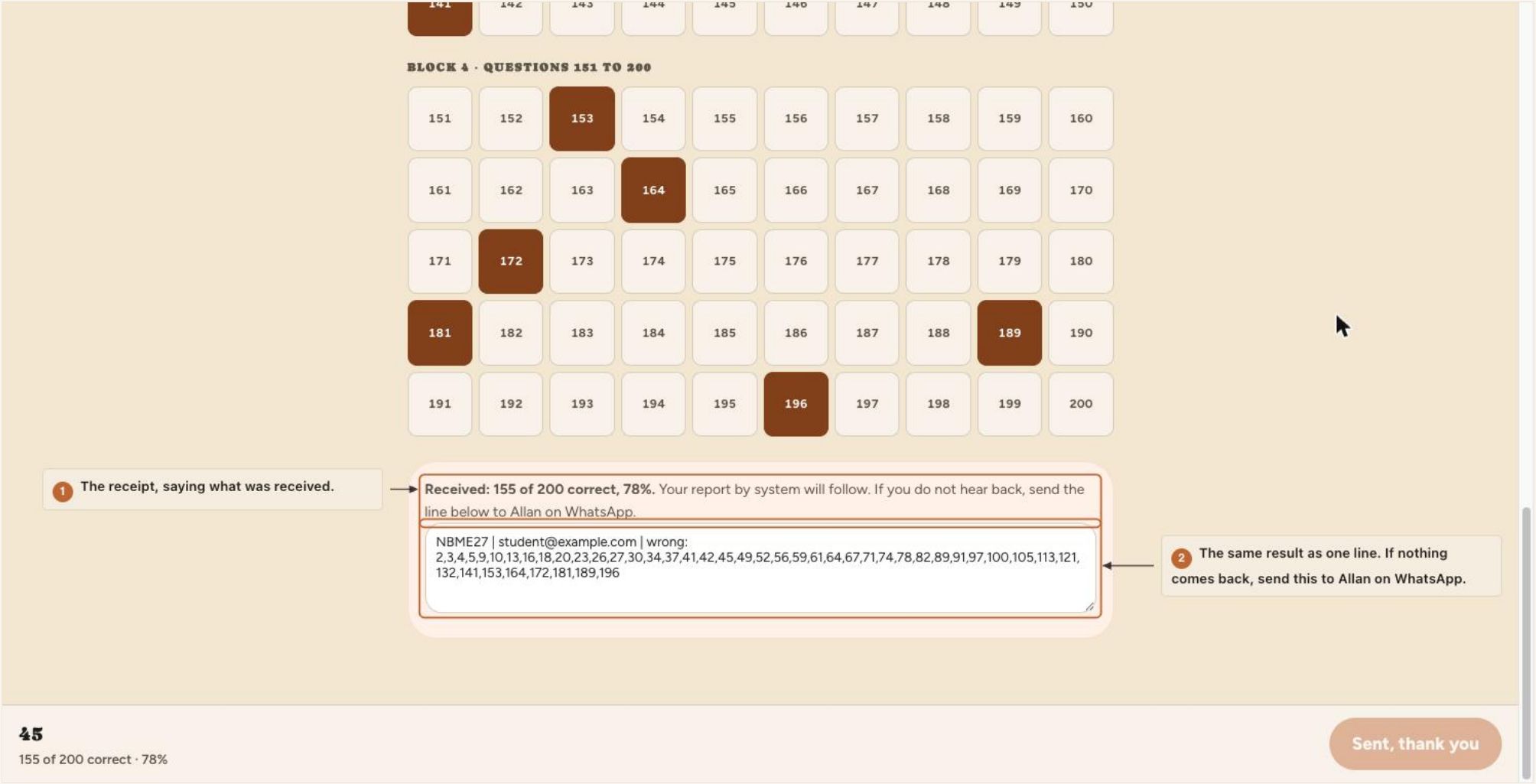
1. Send my result is the only moment anything leaves your browser.
2. It goes under the address you signed in with, so there is nothing to type and nothing to attach.
3. If the send fails, a one line code appears. Send that to Allan on WhatsApp and nothing is lost.

If you sat it on paper



1. Mark one you have sat is for a form you did offline, away from the timer. The same picker rule applies.
2. Pick the form, then tap only the questions you got wrong. Everything you leave alone counts as correct.
3. Most people tap 40 to 70 of the 200. The running count is at the bottom as you go.

The receipt



1. The score comes straight back so you know it landed.
2. The line underneath is the same result in one line. If you never hear back, send that to Allan on WhatsApp.
3. Your report by system and by discipline follows on the dashboard.

Six rules

1 Finish on the device you start on.

Your answers are kept in that browser. Starting on a laptop and finishing on a phone loses the block.

2 Do not share a browser profile mid sitting.

If two of you use the same laptop and the same browser, sign out and use a separate profile or window.

3 The clock does not stop.

Once a block starts it runs to the end, so start a block only when you have seventy five clear minutes.

4 A break is a safe place to stop.

Save and come back later, then finish the remaining blocks before the date the page gives you.

5 Nothing is sent until you mark it.

Your result reaches Allan once, after block 4, when you have marked the whole form.

6 If the send fails, use the one line code.

Copy it and send it to Allan on WhatsApp. It carries everything he needs.

Stuck? Message Allan on WhatsApp. If a send failed, include the one line code the page gave you: it carries the form, your address and every question you marked wrong.